

like a stone wall!" Intended as praise of his resolve, the nickname "Stonewall" stuck for ever after.

Through the following winter in the Shenandoah Valley, Jackson's career as a Civil War general looked uncertain. He seemed indifferent to the hardships imposed on troops by forced marches in foul weather and harsh conditions. Secretive and paranoid, he alienated his subordinate officers by ordering operations with no explanations. When they complained of his incompetence to the Confederate Congress, Jackson resigned in protest at political interference. Although persuaded to stay on, his relations with other officers remained a problem.

Jackson's religious faith gave him an absolute belief in his actions as the expression of a divine will. He was utterly unforgiving toward those whom he saw as falling short of the highest standard. The discipline he imposed was backed up by severe punishment.